Peculiarities of Conjugation

181. In tenses formed upon the Perfect Stem, **v** between two vowels is often lost and contraction takes place.

a. Perfects in **-āvī, -ēvī, -ōvī,** often contract the two vowels into **ā, ē, ō,** respectively: as, **amāsse** for **amāvisse**; **amārim** for **amāverim**; **amāssem** for **amāvissem**; **cōnsuērat** for **cōnsuēverat**; **flēstis** for **flēvistis**; **nōsse** for **nōvisse.** So in perfects in **-vī,** where the **v** is a part of the present stem: as, **commōrat** for **commōverat.**

NOTE.—The first person of the perfect indicative (as, **amāvī**) is never contracted, the third very rarely.

b. Perfects in **-īvī** regularly omit **v,** but rarely contract the vowels except before **st** and **ss,** and very rarely in the third person perfect:—

audieram for **audīveram**; **audīsse** for **audīvisse**; **audīstī** for **audīvistī**; **abiit** for **abīvit**; **abiērunt** for **abīvērunt.**

NOTE 1.—The forms **sīris, sīrit, sīrītis, sīrint,** for **sīveris** etc. (from **sīverō** or **sīverim**), are archaic.

NOTE 2.—In many forms from the perfect stem **is, iss, sis,** are lost in like manner, when **s** would be repeated if they were retained: as, **dīxtī** for **dīxistī** (**x** = **cs**); **trāxe** for **trāxisse**; **ēvāstī** for **ēvāsistī**; **vīxet** for **vīxisset**; **ērēpsēmus** for **ērēpsissēmus**; **dēcēsse** for **dēcessisse.** These forms belong to archaic and colloquial usage.

182. Four verbs,—**dīcō, dūcō, faciō, ferō,**—with their compounds, drop the vowel-termination of the Imperative, making **dīc, dūc, făc, fĕr**; but compounds in **-ficiō** retain it, as, **cōnfice.**

NOTE.—The imperative forms **dīce, dūce, face** (never **fere**), occur in early Latin.

a. For the imperative of **sciō,** the future form **scītō** is always used in the singular, and **scītōte** usually in the plural.

183. The following ancient forms are found chiefly in poetry:

1. In the fourth conjugation, **-ībam, -ībō,** for **-iēbam, -iam** (future). These forms are regular in **eō,** *go* (§ 203).

2. In the present subjunctive, **-im**: as in **duim, perduim,** retained in religious formulas and often in comedy. This form is regular in **sum** and **volō** and their compounds (§§ 170, 199).

3. In the perfect subjunctive and future perfect indicative, **-sim, -sō**: as, **faxim, faxō, iussō, recēpsō** (= **fēcerim** etc.); **ausim** (= **ausus sim**).

4. In the passive infinitive, **-ier**: as, **vocārier** for **vocārī**; **agier** for **agī.**

5. A form in **-āssō, -āssere** is found used as a future perfect: as, **amāssis,** from **amō**; **levāssō,** from **levō**; **impetrāssere,** from **impetrō**; **iūdicāssit,** from **iūdicō** (cf. § 263. 2. *b.* N.).